Groww Case Playbook

20 case studies in one frame · Lead Business Analyst interview prep

- Learn the 7-step frame once. Every case follows it in the same order, so you never freeze.
- Practise: cover the page, read only the prompt, answer out loud, then compare.
- Case numbers are made up for practice. Real facts are tagged and sourced. Do not quote made-up numbers as Groww facts.

The 7-step frame

Step	What you do	A sentence you can say
1. Clarify	Define the metric. Ask 2 or 3 questions. State an assumption.	'Is this quarter on quarter or year on year, and one product or all of them?'
2. Metric tree	Write the formula. Do the arithmetic with numbers.	'Revenue is traders × orders × revenue per order. Let me size each part.'
3. Segment	Cut by product, cohort, channel, platform, tenure. Find what moved.	'I'll cut by product first to see where the fall sits.'
4. Funnel or driver	Walk the steps. Find the step that broke.	'Every step is stable except this one.'
5. Root cause	A cause with a data signature, and who validates it.	'If that is the cause, I'd also see X. I'd confirm with engineering.'
6. Recommendation	Immediate, medium-term, long-term.	'This week..., this quarter..., this year...'
7. Manager answer	Trade-off, should we fix it, size, three-sentence summary.	'What happened, why, and what I would do.'

Manager-level add-ons (on every case):
- **Trade-off:** name what you give up (conversion vs harm, volume vs value, relevance vs revenue).
- **Should we fix it?** Compare the cost of the fix with the money at stake.
- **Size:** a rough ₹ number, with the arithmetic shown.
- **Decision cases (17 to 20):** exposure, then economics, then alternatives, then a test, then a recommendation.

Tags used in this playbook

Tag	Meaning
[Fact]	A real figure from news coverage of Groww's results or industry data. Check the shareholder letter before quoting.
Notes: Paper, n = X	From the research-paper notes. Small samples, mostly convenience samples. Treat as direction, not proof.
Not India	A finding from another country. Use for patterns only.
Hypothetical	A case about something I could not confirm Groww does.
Made up	Case numbers created for practice. This is the default.

Index of cases

Case n is on page n + 2. Cases 1 to 16 are 'something moved, find out why'. Cases 17 to 20 are decisions.

#	Case	Type	Core trade-off	Page
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Case 1 · Revenue down 15% after a SEBI F&O rule

From PDF case 1 · revenue drop

Prompt: Groww's revenue fell about 15% last quarter. Investigate and recommend actions.

1. Clarify

- Is it QoQ or YoY? Whole company or one product line? Any pricing, product or rule change in the quarter?
- Is it only Groww, or did the whole market fall? (Compare with exchange data.)
- Assumption: company-wide QoQ fall, in a quarter when a new SEBI F&O rule took effect.

2. Metric tree

F&O revenue = active F&O traders × orders per trader × revenue per order

Metric (F&O, per quarter)	Before	After	Change
Active F&O traders	1.00M	0.85M	-15%
Orders per trader	120	99	-17.5%
Revenue per order	₹20	₹20	0%
F&O revenue	₹240 Cr	₹168 Cr	-30%
Total revenue (F&O is 50% of the base; other lines flat at ₹240 Cr)	₹480 Cr	₹408 Cr	-15%

Check: 1.00M × 120 × ₹20 = ₹240 Cr. 0.85M × 99 × ₹20 ≈ ₹168 Cr. Fall of ₹72 Cr ÷ ₹480 Cr = 15%. About half the F&O fall is fewer traders, half is fewer orders per trader.

3. Segment

Cut revenue by product. Only one line moved.

Product	Share of revenue (before)	Revenue change	Contribution to the fall
F&O	50%	-30%	-15 pts
Cash stocks	16%	0%	0 pts
MTF (lending)	8%	0%	0 pts
MF, commodities and others	26%	0%	0 pts

4. Which F&O traders dropped?

Trader group	Share of F&O orders (before)	Change in orders
Top 10% by orders	55%	-20%
Middle 40%	35%	-38%
Bottom 50% (small traders)	10%	-55%

Weighted: 0.55 × -20 + 0.35 × -38 + 0.10 × -55 ≈ -30% (total orders).

5. Root cause and who validates it

- The fall starts the week the rule took effect and shows in every cut. That points to a rule effect, not a Groww bug.
- Small traders fell most. That fits a larger contract size and fewer weekly expiries.
- Validate with: compliance (rule date and scope), exchange data on industry active F&O clients, and Groww's share of that total. A flat share means the market moved, not us.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Confirm our share of industry F&O volume is stable. Protect top traders (margin clarity, no outages). Re-forecast the quarter.
Medium-term	Push non-F&O lines: commodities, MTF within credit limits, MF and AMC, cash stocks.
Long-term	Set a target for F&O share of revenue (for example under 40%) and track it monthly.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Protect high-margin F&O revenue vs diversify faster. Pushing small traders back into F&O is the wrong move under these rules.
Should we fix it? You cannot fix a rule. You can limit the damage and rebalance the mix.
Size: If F&O falls another 10%, that is about ₹17 Cr a quarter (10% × ₹168 Cr).
Manager summary: Revenue fell 15% because F&O revenue fell 30% after the SEBI rule, with the biggest drop among small traders. Other lines were flat. I would protect top traders, confirm our share is stable, and speed up non-F&O revenue.

Sources and tags: [Fact] F&O about 50% of revenue (Q1 FY27 results coverage). SEBI curbs from Nov 2024: larger contract size, fewer weekly expiries. Individual F&O traders fell to 87.5 lakh in FY26. Case numbers are made up.

Case 2 · KYC to first deposit fell from 62% to 51%

From PDF case 2 · conversion drop

Prompt: Of users who finish KYC, the share who deposit money within 7 days fell from 62% to 51% in six weeks. What happened?

1. Clarify

- When did the fall start? All platforms? Any release, bank or payment change around that date?
- Did the mix of users change (a new campaign, a new channel)?
- Assumption: app-wide fall, KYC volume flat, installs up 15% from a new paid campaign.

2. Metric tree

Funded users = KYC completed × deposit rate within 7 days

Per week	Before	After	Change
KYC completed	180k	180k	0%
Deposit within 7 days	62%	51%	-11 pts
Funded users	111.6k	91.8k	-19.8k (-18%)

The loss is all in the deposit rate. KYC volume is flat.

3. Segment

Platform cut. One platform explains the fall.

Platform	Share of KYC	Deposit rate before	Deposit rate after
Android	70%	61%	46%
iOS	30%	65%	63%
Total	100%	62%	51%

Channel check: organic 63% to 49%, paid 58% to 44%. Both fall, so channel mix is not the cause.

4. Funnel (Android only)

Step (step rate)	Before	After
Opened deposit page	90%	89%
Started payment	80%	79%
Payment succeeded	85%	65%
Deposited within 7 days (product)	61%	46%

Check: 0.90 × 0.80 × 0.85 = 61%. 0.89 × 0.79 × 0.65 = 46%. Only payment success moved.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Signature: the fall starts on the release date, only on Android, only at the payment-success step.
- Likely cause: a payment or UPI change in a recent Android release, or one bank or gateway failing.
- Validate with: payments engineering (error codes by bank and app version), release log, gateway dashboard.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Roll back the Android change or route to a backup gateway. Message users whose payment failed, with a retry link.
Medium-term	Alert when payment success is under 90%. Add release health checks.
Long-term	Multi-gateway routing and canary releases (small rollout first).

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Rolling back delays other features in that release. Staying costs deposits every day.
Should we fix it? Yes. It is the cheapest and fastest recovery.
Size: Restoring Android to 61% adds (61% - 46%) × 70% × 180k = 18.9k deposits a week, about 95% of the 19.8k loss.

Manager summary: First deposits fell because payment success on Android dropped from 85% to 65% after a release. That explains about 95% of the lost deposits. I would roll back, retry failed payments, and add payment alerts.

Sources and tags: Notes: 45.5% report occasional crashes or delays and 9.1% frequent ones (Platforms-IJRPR, n = 44). Case numbers are made up.

Case 3 · New investors are not coming back

From PDF case 3 · repeat purchase

Prompt: Customers place a first order but not a second. The 90-day repeat rate is falling. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Define the metric: share of first-order users who place another completed order (any product) within 90 days.
- Is it falling for every group, or only some? Did acquisition change?
- Assumption: the repeat rate fell from 43% to 38% over four monthly cohorts.

2. Metric tree

Repeat rate = sum of (segment share × segment repeat rate)

Monthly cohort	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr
90-day repeat rate	43%	42%	40%	38%

It falls steadily for newer cohorts.

3. Segment

Cut by first product. Each segment's own repeat rate did not change. The mix did.

First product	Share of new users (Jan)	Share (Apr)	90-day repeat (both months)
SIP or MF first	38%	30%	58%
Cash stock first	38%	30%	41%
F&O first	16%	15%	22%
IPO first	8%	25%	19%
Overall	100%	100%	Jan 43% → Apr 38%

4. Mix effect vs rate effect

Item	Value
April repeat rate (actual)	38%
April rate if the mix were as in January	43%
Mix effect	-5 pts
Rate effect (segments getting worse)	about 0 pts

Check Apr: 0.30 × 58 + 0.30 × 41 + 0.15 × 22 + 0.25 × 19 ≈ 38. Jan: 0.38 × 58 + 0.38 × 41 + 0.16 × 22 + 0.08 × 19 ≈ 43.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- A hot IPO period brought many one-time IPO users (8% to 25% of new users). They repeat at 19%.
- No segment got worse. The headline fell because the mix shifted. This is a mix problem, not a product problem.
- Validate with: growth team (campaign and IPO calendar) and a same-segment repeat rate by month.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Report the mix-adjusted repeat rate. Do not trigger a product panic.
Medium-term	A next-step journey for IPO-first users after allotment: a related watchlist or a small SIP start.
Long-term	Track IPO-driven users and core users as separate KPIs.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: IPO campaigns raise installs and revenue now but bring users who rarely come back.
Should we fix it? Yes for the IPO-first group. The core business is fine.
Size: If IPO-first users repeated at 30% instead of 19%, the overall rate would rise by 0.25 × 11 = 2.75 pts.

Manager summary: The repeat rate fell from 43% to 38% because IPO-first users went from 8% to 25% of new users and repeat at only 19%. Each segment is stable. I would report a mix-adjusted metric and build a next-step path for IPO users.

Sources and tags: Notes: 52.9% use trading apps rarely (Literacy-IJCRM, n = 102). Not India: '80% of apps deleted within 90 days' is a secondary citation (Retention-UCT). Case numbers are made up.

Case 4 · Cost to serve per client up 20%

From PDF case 4 · cost increase

Prompt: Cost to serve per active client rose 20% over two quarters. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Which costs are included? Is the rise in total cost, in cost per client, or both?
- Which cost lines are growing on purpose (for example lending)?
- Assumption: cost per active client per quarter went from ₹400 to ₹480.

2. Metric tree

Cost per client = (support + tech + KYC and payments + cost of funds) ÷ active clients

₹ per active client per quarter	Before	After	Change	Share of rise
Support	90	120	+30	38%
Tech and infrastructure	150	156	+6	8%
KYC and payments	60	61	+1	1%
Cost of funds (lending)	100	143	+43	54%
Total	400	480	+80 (+20%)	100%

3. Segment

Cut by client group. Lending users are a growing share of clients.

Group	Share of clients (before → after)	Cost per client before	Cost per client after
MTF or loan users	6% → 9%	₹900	₹1,000
Other clients	94% → 91%	₹368	₹429

Check: 0.06 × 900 + 0.94 × 368 ≈ 400. 0.09 × 1,000 + 0.91 × 429 ≈ 480.

4. Support drivers

Metric	Before	After
Tickets per client per quarter	0.80	1.10 (+37.5%)
Cost per ticket	₹112.5	₹109
Support cost per client	₹90	₹120
Failed orders and failed SIP debits, share of tickets	35%	56%

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Two different stories. Cost of funds rises with the lending book. That is a good cost if interest income rises more.
- The support rise is waste. Tickets per client rose 37.5%, driven by failed orders and failed debits (see cases 11 and 14).
- Validate with: finance (net interest margin on MTF), support operations (ticket reasons), engineering.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Find the top 3 ticket reasons and fix them (failed debits, order failures, KYC status).
Medium-term	Self-serve status pages and a bot for simple tickets.
Long-term	A contribution margin per client dashboard, so cost is always read against revenue.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Growing the lending book raises cost and revenue together. Support growth raises cost only.
Should we fix it? Fix the support part. Judge the lending part on margin.
Size: Bringing tickets back to 0.8 per client saves ₹30 per client. For 10M clients that is ₹30 Cr a quarter.

Manager summary: Cost per client rose ₹80. Cost of funds explains 54% and is tied to lending growth. Support explains 38% and comes from avoidable failures. I would fix the failures and judge lending cost against its margin.

Sources and tags: [Fact] MTF was 8% of revenue vs 3% a year earlier (Q1 FY27 coverage). Notes: support satisfaction 38.33% (Satisfaction-IJRD, n = 60). Case numbers are made up.

Case 5 · Active investor growth has stalled

From PDF case 5 · growth stalled

Prompt: Net active clients have been flat for two quarters. Marketing spend is unchanged. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Define 'active': at least one completed order in the last 90 days.
- Is the stall from fewer new clients, more churn, or both?
- Assumption: net active clients went from +20k a quarter to zero.

2. Metric tree

Net active = newly activated + reactivated - churned

'000 clients per quarter	Before	After	Change
Newly activated	300	270	-30
Reactivated	40	40	0
Churned	320	310	-10 (better)
Net active	+20	0	-20

The stall comes from activation. Churn actually improved.

3. Segment

Cut new activations by source.

Source ('000 activated)	Before	After
Organic	150	150
Paid search	80	75
Paid social	70	45
Total	300	270

4. New-client funnel (per 1,000k signups)

Step	Before	After
Signups	1,000k	1,000k
KYC completed	60%	58%
Deposit within 30 days	55%	52%
First trade	90%	90%
Newly activated	297k	271k

Check: 1,000k × 0.58 × 0.52 × 0.90 ≈ 271k.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- The top of the funnel is unchanged. Two steps after signup leaked: KYC (60% to 58%) and first deposit (55% to 52%).
- Paid social is the weakest source. Market weakness also matters: the whole industry lost clients in the same period.
- Validate with: growth (campaign quality), payments (deposit failures, see case 2), and a deposit rate by cohort.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Fix KYC and first-deposit drop-offs. Do not raise acquisition spend yet.
Medium-term	Nudges for first deposit with a small suggested amount.
Long-term	A reactivation programme for clients dormant 60 to 180 days.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: More acquisition spend vs fixing activation.
Should we fix it? Yes. Buying more signups does not fix a leak that sits after signup.
Size: +3 pts of deposit conversion = 1,000k × 58% × 3% × 90% ≈ 15.7k more activations a quarter.

Manager summary: Growth stalled because new activations fell 10% while churn improved. The leak is KYC and first deposit, not signups. I would fix those steps before spending more on acquisition.

Sources and tags: [Fact] In Q1 FY27 Groww added 1.15 lakh net active NSE clients while the industry lost about 2.6 lakh (results coverage). Case numbers are made up.

Case 6 · Client NPS fell from 62 to 51

From PDF case 6 · NPS drop

Prompt: Client NPS declined from 62 to 51 over the last quarter. What happened?

1. Clarify

- Is the fall broad or concentrated? Which clients? Any outage, support or product change?
- How is NPS collected (after which event) and has that changed?
- Assumption: survey method unchanged, a quarter that included several volatile market days.

2. Metric tree

NPS change = sum of the change in each driver's contribution

Driver	NPS points
Order failures and delays	-7
Support speed	-3
Charges clarity	-1
App design	0
Total (62 → 51)	-11

3. Segment

Cut by client type. The fall is concentrated among traders.

Client type	Share of clients	NPS before	NPS after
F&O and intraday traders	20%	52	33
Delivery investors	40%	64	50
SIP and MF investors	40%	66	60
Overall (weighted)	100%	62	51

4. What changed on peak days (6 high-volume days)

Metric	Before	After
Failed orders at market open	0.8%	3.4%
App response time (p95)	0.9 s	2.6 s
Support first response	2 min	6 min
Tickets per 1,000 clients, peak days	15	41

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Order failures on peak days hit the most active traders hardest, and support slowed on the same days.
- Charges clarity is a small piece. App design did not move.
- Validate with: engineering incident logs, NPS comments grouped by theme, support operations data.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Add capacity before market open. Show a status banner during incidents. Staff support up on peak days.
Medium-term	Auto-retry and failed-order alerts. Clear charge breakdown before each order.
Long-term	Load testing before volatile days and an SLA dashboard shared with leadership.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Peak capacity costs money, but traders carry a large share of revenue.
Should we fix it? Yes, and start with the F&O and intraday group.
Size: Traders are 20% of clients. If they bring about half of revenue and 5% leave, we lose about 2.5% of revenue.

Manager summary: NPS fell 11 points mostly because order failures and slow support on peak days hit traders. I would fix peak capacity and support staffing first, then improve charge clarity.

Sources and tags: Notes: 45.5% report occasional crashes or delays, 9.1% frequent (Platforms-IJRPR, n = 44). Support satisfaction 38.33%, charge transparency 43.33% (Satisfaction-IJRD, n = 60). Case numbers are made up.

Case 7 · How to measure success of a new product

From PDF case 7 · new category launch

Prompt: Groww launched commodity trading about a year ago. How would you measure whether it is a success?

1. Clarify

- What is the goal: revenue, new clients, diversification away from F&O, or retention? Management says it wants diversification.
- Over what period do we judge it?
- Assumption: the goal is incremental profit and less dependence on F&O.

2. Metric tree

North star = incremental contribution margin from commodities = commodity margin - margin lost in F&O

Layer	Metrics
Business	Commodity revenue, active commodity traders, market share
Clients	Share new to Groww, 90-day repeat rate
Quality and risk	Client loss rate, margin shortfalls, complaints
Financial	Contribution margin per trader, net of F&O cannibalisation

3. Segment

Cut commodity traders by where they came from, and check each group's quality.

Source of trader	Share	90-day repeat
Existing F&O traders	55%	62%
Existing cash or MF clients	25%	48%
New to Groww	20%	35%

4. Incrementality (per quarter, made up)

Item	Value
Commodity revenue	₹60 Cr
Less F&O revenue that shifted over	-₹18 Cr
Net incremental revenue	₹42 Cr
At 50% contribution margin	₹21 Cr

Guardrails and alert levels: beginners over 25% of commodity traders; traders down over 20% in 30 days above 45%; margin shortfalls above 3%; complaints above 5 per 1,000.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Call it a success if: incremental margin is positive for two quarters, the new-to-Groww share rises, and 90-day repeat is at least as good as for stock traders.
- Market share alone is a vanity metric. A product that only moves F&O traders sideways adds little.
- Validate with: finance (margin and cost), risk (loss and margin-call data), product.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Agree the scorecard and the incrementality method before reporting results.
Medium-term	Use a matched cohort or a test to separate new activity from shifted activity.
Long-term	Set a revenue-mix target so the product earns its place in diversification.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Market share and volume vs profit and risk. Commodity derivatives carry rule risk like F&O.
Should we fix it? Invest more only if incremental margin is positive after cannibalisation.
Size: ₹60 Cr gross becomes ₹42 Cr incremental after shifted F&O revenue, about ₹21 Cr of margin.

Manager summary: I would judge commodities by incremental contribution margin, not share. Success means margin stays positive after F&O cannibalisation, new clients grow, and loss guardrails hold.

Sources and tags: [Fact] 29% commodity derivatives market share in under a year; management expects revenue to diversify away from equity derivatives (Q1 FY27 coverage). Case numbers are made up.

Case 8 · Rewards cost ₹20 Cr and revenue barely moved

From PDF case 8 · coupon program

Prompt: Groww spent ₹20 Cr on brokerage waivers and referral rewards last quarter. Revenue barely changed. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- The key question is not total revenue. It is the incremental effect of the rewards.
- Was there a holdout group that did not get rewards? How was it chosen?
- Assumption: a randomised holdout of equal size exists.

2. Metric tree

Incremental ROI = incremental revenue over 12 months ÷ reward spend

Metric	Reward group	Holdout	Lift
Funded rate	18.0%	16.0%	+2.0 pts
90-day active rate	9.0%	8.5%	+0.5 pts
Revenue per user (quarter)	₹26	₹25	+₹1
Spend ₹20 Cr → incremental 12-month revenue ₹9 Cr			ROI 0.45x

3. Segment

Where did the money go, and what did each part return?

Segment	Spend	Incremental value	ROI
Already-active users	₹13 Cr	₹1 Cr	0.08x
Dormant users (reactivation)	₹4 Cr	₹3 Cr	0.75x
New users	₹3 Cr	₹5 Cr	1.7x
Total	₹20 Cr	₹9 Cr	0.45x

4. Leakage

Cause	Evidence
Blanket rewards	65% of spend (₹13 Cr) went to users who were already active
Referral abuse	6% of referral accounts flagged as multiple accounts by one person
Low-quality referred users	90-day active rate 4% vs 9% for organic users

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Most of the money went to people who would have traded anyway. That is spend with no extra behaviour.
- Rewards work for new users (1.7x) and partly for dormant users (0.75x). They do not work for active users (0.08x).
- Validate with: finance (spend by segment), risk and fraud team (duplicate accounts), growth (referral rules).

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Stop blanket rewards for already-active users. Add fraud checks to referrals.
Medium-term	Target new and dormant users. Cap rewards per user. Pay on a funded first trade, not on signup.
Long-term	Use an uplift model to give a reward only where it changes behaviour.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Growth volume now vs return on each rupee. Cutting rewards may lower sign-ups a little.
Should we fix it? Yes. This is the cheapest improvement in the playbook.
Size: Moving 70% of the ₹13 Cr (₹9.1 Cr) from active users (0.08x) to new users (1.7x) adds about ₹14 Cr of value, before diminishing returns.

Manager summary: The rewards returned 0.45x because 65% of the spend went to users who were already active. They returned 1.7x on new users. I would stop blanket rewards and pay only for new and dormant users on a funded first trade.

Sources and tags: Case numbers are made up. 'Diminishing returns' means ROI will fall as spend on new users grows.

Case 9 · Installs up 30%, funded users flat

From PDF case 9 · traffic up, revenue flat

Prompt: A marketing campaign lifted installs by 30%, but the number of funded users did not change. What happened?

1. Clarify

- Funded user means a user who deposited money. Over what period?
- Which channels grew? Was the campaign optimised for installs or for funded users?
- Assumption: a paid social campaign optimised for installs.

2. Metric tree

Funded users = installs × install-to-funded rate

Metric	Before	After	Change
Installs	1.00M	1.30M	+30%
Install-to-funded rate	8.0%	6.15%	-23%
Funded users	80k	80k	0%

The drop in rate cancels the growth in installs: 1.30M × 6.15% ≈ 80k.

3. Segment

Cut by channel. The growth is all in paid social, and it does not fund.

Channel	Installs (before → after)	Funded rate	Funded users (before → after)
Organic	600k → 610k	9% → 9%	54.0k → 54.9k
Paid search	200k → 200k	8% → 8%	16.0k → 16.0k
Paid social	200k → 490k	5% → 1.8%	10.0k → 8.8k
Total	1.00M → 1.30M	8.0% → 6.2%	80.0k → 79.7k

4. Cost per funded user (paid social)

Metric	Before	After
Cost per install	₹30	₹30
Spend	₹0.6 Cr	₹1.47 Cr
Funded users	10.0k	8.8k
Cost per funded user	₹600	₹1,670

Check: ₹1.47 Cr ÷ 8.8k ≈ ₹1,670.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- The campaign was bought and judged on installs. It reached a low-intent audience: the funded rate fell from 5% to 1.8%.
- Install cost looks flat (₹30) but cost per funded user nearly tripled.
- Validate with: growth and marketing (campaign targeting and optimisation goal), and funded rate by placement.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Switch the campaign goal from installs to funded users or KYC complete. Cut the worst placements.
Medium-term	Build look-alike audiences from funded users.
Long-term	Bid on predicted lifetime value, not on installs.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Install volume is easy to report. Funded users are what earns money.
Should we fix it? Yes. The extra spend bought almost nothing.
Size: If paid social funded at 5% again, 490k installs would give 24.5k funded users instead of 8.8k, which is +15.7k.

Manager summary: Installs rose 30% but funded users stayed at 80k because the new paid social installs funded at only 1.8%. Cost per funded user went from ₹600 to ₹1,670. I would optimise the campaign for funded users, not installs.

Sources and tags: Case numbers are made up.

Case 10 · MF distribution revenue down 20%

From PDF case 10 · one category dropped

Prompt: Mutual fund distribution revenue fell 20% while other lines stayed stable. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Is it AUM, commission rate, or both? Is it market-driven or flow-driven?
- Did the industry see the same fall?
- Assumption: a quarter with falling equity markets and heavy redemptions.

2. Metric tree

MF revenue = average AUM × trail commission rate

Metric	Before	After	Change
Average AUM (index)	100	84	-16%
Trail rate (basis points)	40	38	-5%
MF revenue (index)	100	80	-20%

Check: 0.84 × 0.95 ≈ 0.80.

3. Segment

AUM bridge: what moved AUM?

Item	Index points
Opening AUM	100
Market movement	-9
SIP inflows (net of stops)	+3
Lump-sum redemptions	-10
Closing AUM	84

4. Mix by fund type

Fund type	Trail rate (bps)	Share of AUM (before)	AUM change
Equity funds	55	60%	-24%
Debt funds	20	25%	0%
Index and ETF	15	15%	-10%

Equity fell most, so the blended trail rate dropped from about 40 to 38 bps.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- About 56% of the AUM fall is market movement (9 of 16 points). That part we do not control.
- The rest is net outflows (redemptions larger than SIP inflows). The rate falls because the mix moved toward lower-commission funds.
- Validate with: finance (AUM bridge), MF operations (flows by fund type), and AMFI industry flows.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Report market effect and flow effect separately, so leadership sees what is controllable.
Medium-term	SIP start and SIP retention campaigns. Retry failed debits (see case 14).
Long-term	Grow recurring lines that depend less on the market, such as the AMC.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Pushing high-commission equity funds would lift revenue but is a mis-selling risk in a falling market.
Should we fix it? Fix only the controllable part: net flows and SIP retention.
Size: Of the 16-point AUM fall, about 9 points are market movement. Each 1 point of AUM is about 1% of MF revenue.

Manager summary: MF revenue fell 20% because average AUM fell 16% and the blended rate fell 5%. More than half the AUM fall is market movement. I would focus on SIP retention and flows, not on pushing high-commission funds.

Sources and tags: [Fact] Industry SIP inflows hit a record ₹32,490 Cr in Sep 2026; the stoppage ratio of 78.53% includes SIPs that completed their term. Groww's AMC AUM grew 140% in a year (Q1 FY27 coverage). Case numbers are made up.

Case 11 · Complaints on failed orders doubled

From PDF case 11 · complaints doubled

Prompt: Complaints about failed or delayed orders doubled last month. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Is it all products and all hours, or concentrated? Did order volume change?
- Any release or exchange-side change? What counts as a 'delayed' order?
- Assumption: 2.0M orders a day, volume flat.

2. Metric tree

Complaints = orders × failure rate × complaints per failed order

Per day	Before	After	Change
Orders	2.0M	2.0M	0%
Failed or delayed orders	0.9%	1.9%	+1.0 pt
Complaints per failed order	5%	5%	0%
Complaints	900	1,900	+111%

The failure rate doubled. Behaviour of complaining did not change.

3. Segment

Cut by time of day and by product.

Slice	Share of orders	Failure rate before → after
Market open (9:15 to 9:30)	25%	1.5% → 5.0%
Rest of the day	75%	0.7% → 0.9%
F&O	30%	1.2% → 4.8%
Cash stocks and others	70%	0.8% → 0.7%

Both cuts point to the same place: F&O orders at market open.

4. Order path

Step	Before	After
App to broker server, success	99.9%	99.9%
Broker to exchange gateway latency (p95, open window)	180 ms	900 ms
Exchange rejection rate	0.4%	0.4%
Confirmation delay over 3 seconds	1.0%	5.5%

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Signature: failures only at market open, only for F&O, and the delay sits between our server and the exchange gateway.
- Likely cause: not enough order-routing capacity at the open, or a recent release that slows F&O order handling.
- Validate with: engineering logs, exchange response codes, release timeline.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Add capacity before the open. Show a status banner. Staff support up for the first 30 minutes.
Medium-term	Pre-open load tests and automatic retries.
Long-term	Redundant routing and a failed-order service level, reported weekly.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Spare capacity costs money all day for a 15-minute peak. Failures cost trust and trades.
Should we fix it? Yes. It is concentrated, so the fix is targeted.
Size: Open-window orders are 500k a day. Failures rose from 1.5% to 5.0%, so 17.5k extra failed orders a day, about ₹3.5 lakh of brokerage a day at ₹20 an order.

Manager summary: Complaints doubled because the failure rate doubled, almost all of it on F&O orders at market open. I would add capacity before the open, show a status banner, and track failed orders at open as a daily metric.

Sources and tags: Notes: 45.5% occasionally and 9.1% frequently report crashes or delays (Platforms-IJRPR, n = 44); 66.67% report connectivity issues (Satisfaction-IJRD, n = 60). Not Groww: a ₹3 crore compensation claim followed another broker's outage in Apr 2023 (Platforms-IJRPR p.6178, secondary). Case numbers are made up.

Case 12 · Cost per funded user up 40%

From PDF case 12 · CAC up 40%

Prompt: Cost per funded user (our CAC) rose 40% over two quarters. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Is it higher ad prices, lower conversion, or both? Which channels?
- What is the lifetime value, so we can judge if the new cost is still acceptable?
- Assumption: CAC = marketing spend ÷ funded users.

2. Metric tree

Cost per funded user = cost per install ÷ install-to-funded rate

Metric	Before	After	Change
Spend	₹10.0 Cr	₹11.2 Cr	+12%
Funded users	100k	80k	-20%
Cost per funded user	₹1,000	₹1,400	+40%
Cost per install	₹40	₹50	+25%
Install-to-funded rate	4.0%	3.57%	-11%

Price up 25% and quality down 11% gives about +40% (1.25 ÷ 0.89 ≈ 1.40).

3. Segment

Cut by channel (illustrative). One channel is the outlier.

Channel	Share of spend (after)	Cost per funded user	12-month value	Value ÷ cost (after)
Search	40%	₹900 → ₹990	₹4,500	4.5x
Affiliates	20%	₹1,100 → ₹1,155	₹4,200	3.6x
Paid social	40%	₹1,100 → ₹1,955	₹2,500	1.3x

4. Economics

Metric	Before	After
Value of a funded user (12-month contribution)	₹4,200	₹4,200
Cost per funded user	₹1,000	₹1,400
Value ÷ cost	4.2x	3.0x
Payback	about 3 months	about 4 months

₹4,200 over 12 months is ₹350 a month: 1,000 ÷ 350 ≈ 2.9 months; 1,400 ÷ 350 = 4.0 months.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Ad prices rose in paid social (auction pressure) and the audience got weaker (low-intent users).
- The economics still work overall (3.0x), but paid social is near break-even (1.3x).
- Validate with: growth analytics (cost per install and funded rate by channel), finance (value per funded user).

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Cut the worst social placements and campaigns under 2x.
Medium-term	Shift budget to search and affiliates up to their saturation point. Add referral from funded users, with fraud checks.
Long-term	Bid on predicted lifetime value.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Cutting spend lowers total funded users. Holding spend lowers profit per user.
Should we fix it? Reallocate, do not cut blindly. Keep any channel above about 2x.
Size: Moving ₹1.3 Cr from social (₹1,955 per funded user) to search (₹990) gives 13.1k funded users instead of 6.6k, about +6.5k if search can absorb it.

Manager summary: Cost per funded user rose 40% because installs cost 25% more and fewer of them fund. Paid social is the outlier at 1.3x value ÷ cost. I would reallocate budget to channels above 2x and move to lifetime-value bidding.

Sources and tags: Case numbers are made up. Channel figures are illustrative.

Case 13 · Stock search up, orders down

From PDF case 13 · search up, orders down

Prompt: More clients are using search and Explore than ever, but stock orders have fallen. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Search usage up is normally good. Where does the search journey break?
- Did the ranking, the layout or the product list change recently?
- Assumption: a ranking update shipped four weeks ago.

2. Metric tree

Orders = searches × click rate × order rate per page view

Per month	Before	After	Change
Searches	10.0M	12.0M	+20%
Result click rate	40%	25%	-15 pts
Stock page views	4.0M	3.0M	-25%
Order rate per page view	10%	10%	0%
Orders	400k	300k	-25%

Check: 10.0M × 40% × 10% = 400k. 12.0M × 25% × 10% = 300k. Only the click rate moved.

3. Segment

Cut by user age on the app and by search type.

Slice	Share of searches	Click rate before → after
New users (under 90 days)	30%	38% → 14%
Existing users	70%	41% → 30%
Company-name searches	60%	45% → 18%
Other searches	40%	32% → 36%

4. Search quality

Metric	Before	After
Click-through rate	40%	25%
Searches repeated (reformulation)	15%	35%
Zero-result rate	2%	2%
Company-name searches where the first result is an F&O contract	5%	48%

5. Root cause and who validates it

- After a ranking change, F&O contracts began to appear above the cash stock for company-name searches.
- New users are hit hardest, since they do not know the difference. Zero-result rate is flat, so it is relevance, not coverage.
- Validate with: the search team (ranking release notes), an A/B test of old vs new ranking.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Roll back the ranking change. Show the cash stock first and contracts in a separate tab.
Medium-term	Track click rate, reformulation rate and zero-result rate on a dashboard.
Long-term	Personalised ranking by what the client usually trades.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Showing contracts first may raise revenue per click but lowers relevance and confuses beginners.
Should we fix it? Yes. Every later step depends on search relevance.
Size: 100k fewer orders a month at ₹20 an order is ₹20 lakh of brokerage a month, plus beginners who leave.

Manager summary: Searches rose 20% but orders fell 25% because the click rate dropped from 40% to 25% after a ranking change put F&O contracts first. I would roll back and keep cash stocks and contracts apart.

Sources and tags: Notes: 68.3% feel confused when stocks and derivatives share one app; 66.67% want one app with separate sections (Satisfaction-IJRD, n = 60). Case numbers are made up.

Case 14 · SIP failed debits rose from 5% to 9%

From PDF case 14 · returns doubled

Prompt: The failure rate on SIP debits rose from about 5% to 9% in a quarter. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Is it every bank and every mandate type? Is it failed debits or cancelled SIPs?
- Did we change anything in the SIP setup flow?
- Assumption: 2.0M SIP debit attempts a month.

2. Metric tree

Failure rate = failed debits ÷ attempted debits

Per month	Before	After	Change
Attempted debits	2.0M	2.0M	0%
Failure rate	4.8%	9.1%	+4.3 pts
Failed debits	96k	182k	+86k

3. Segment

Cut by mandate type. One type explains it.

Mandate type	Share of debits	Failure rate before → after
eNACH	60%	4.0% → 4.5%
UPI AutoPay	40%	6.0% → 16.0%
Total	100%	4.8% → 9.1%

4. Failure reasons (share of failures)

Reason	Before	After	Points of all debits (before → after)
Insufficient balance	55%	35%	2.6 → 3.2
Limit exceeded	15%	40%	0.7 → 3.6
Bank technical error	20%	20%	1.0 → 1.8
Other	10%	5%	0.5 → 0.5

Limit-exceeded failures grew from 0.7 to 3.6 points. Insufficient balance barely moved.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Signature: the rise is only on UPI AutoPay, and limit-exceeded is the reason that exploded. Likely a lower limit at some banks, hitting larger SIP amounts.
- This is a setup and limit problem, not a client-intent problem. Clients still want to invest.
- Validate with: payments team (bank and mandate logs), SIP amount distribution of the failures.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Retry failed debits within 3 days. Message the client with a fix: switch to eNACH or lower the amount.
Medium-term	Show the mandate limit during SIP setup. Warn when the SIP amount is above it.
Long-term	A failure dashboard by bank and mandate type with alerts.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: A stricter setup flow adds friction. A message after failure costs almost nothing.
Should we fix it? Yes. It is cheap and protects the SIP base.
Size: Excess failures are about 4.3 pts × 2.0M = 86k a month. A retry that recovers 40% saves about 34k debits a month.

Manager summary: Failed SIP debits rose from 4.8% to 9.1%, driven by UPI AutoPay limit failures. I would retry and message affected clients now, then show limits at setup and monitor by bank.

Sources and tags: [Fact] Industry SIP stoppage ratio (78.53% in Sep 2026) includes SIPs that completed their term, so failed debits are a separate, controllable leak. Case numbers are made up.

Case 15 · A nudge lifts first trades +2%. Launch?

From PDF case 15 · A/B test

Prompt: An A/B test of a nudge ('Start with ₹500 in a stock') shows a 2% lift in first stock orders. Should we launch it?

1. Clarify

- Do not answer 'yes' yet. Is the result valid: random split, enough sample, no sample-ratio problem?
- What are the guardrails, and what did they do?
- Assumption: 1.0M eligible users split 500k and 500k, split is clean, 14-day read.

2. Metric tree

Value of the nudge = extra first traders × quality of those traders

Item	Value
Users per arm	500k
First stock order within 14 days	5.00% (control) vs 5.10% (nudge), p = 0.02
Extra first traders if launched to 1.0M eligible users	+1,000
Share of new traders losing over 10% in 30 days	40% (control) vs 52% (nudge)

3. Segment

Cut by tenure. The harm is concentrated in beginners.

Group	Change in conversion	Change in early-loss share
Under 6 months on the app	+3.1%	+16 pts
6 months or more	+0.8%	+3 pts

4. Primary metric vs guardrails

Metric	Control	Nudge	Verdict
First-order conversion (primary)	5.00%	5.10%	Win
7-day retention of new traders	70%	66%	Fails
Early-loss share (over 10% in 30 days)	40%	52%	Fails
Notification opt-out	6.0%	8.5%	Fails
Revenue per exposed user	₹10.0	₹10.2	Small win

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Why not ship as is: three guardrails fail. The nudge brings in more people, but they lose early and leave.
- Check what the extra 1,000 traders are: mostly beginners who buy volatile stocks at the nudge's suggested amount.
- Validate with: experimentation team (sample-ratio and power checks), risk team (loss data), product (nudge content).

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Do not launch as is.
Medium-term	Redesign: a low-volatility starter basket, a small first amount, a loss-explainer after the first order. Retest with the same guardrails.
Long-term	Keep a 5% long-term holdout and judge nudges on 90-day active traders, not first orders.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Conversion gain vs investor harm and regulatory attention on retail losses.
Should we fix it? Fix the nudge, not the test. Do not ship the current version.
Size: Launch adds about 1,000 first traders, but early-loss traders rise from 20,000 to 26,520 (about +6,500) per 1.0M eligible users.

Manager summary: The nudge lifts first orders by 2%, but retention falls 4 points, early losses rise 12 points and opt-outs rise. The gain is 1,000 traders and the cost is about 6,500 more early losers. I would not ship it, and I would retest a safer design.

Sources and tags: [Fact] Retail traders lost ₹91,685 Cr in F&O in FY26 (coverage; F&O only, used here as context). Notes: 78% trade more and 61.67% say they take more risk after using apps (Satisfaction-IJRD, n = 60, self-reported). Case numbers are made up.

Case 16 · Support productivity down 15%

From PDF case 16 · warehouse productivity

Prompt: Tickets resolved per support agent fell 15%. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Define productivity: tickets resolved per agent per day. Did the numerator fall or the denominator rise?
- Did we change the tools, the queue or the ticket mix (for example a chatbot)?
- Assumption: a chatbot started handling simple tickets three months ago.

2. Metric tree

Tickets per agent = (agent minutes utilised) ÷ average handle time

Per agent per day	Before	After	Change
Utilised minutes	380	384	+1%
Average handle time (min)	9.5	11.3	+19%
Tickets resolved	40	34	-15%

3. Segment

Ticket mix reaching human agents. Each type's handle time barely changed.

Type	Share (before)	Share (after)	Handle time
Simple (status checks)	55%	30%	5 min
Complex (failed debits, KYC issues)	45%	70%	15 → 14 min

Check: 0.55 × 5 + 0.45 × 15 = 9.5. 0.30 × 5 + 0.70 × 14 = 11.3.

4. Whole-system view (10,000 tickets a day)

Metric	Before	After
Tickets handled by agents	10,000	6,429
Tickets resolved by the bot	0	3,571 (36%)
Agents needed	250	189 (-24%)
Cost per resolved ticket (agent ₹1,500 a day, bot ₹0.4 lakh a day)	₹37.5	₹32.4 (-14%)

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Per-agent productivity fell because the bot took the easy tickets. Agents now handle harder ones. This is a mix effect, not slower agents.
- The right measure is cost per resolved ticket (down 14%), together with resolution rate and satisfaction.
- Validate with: support operations (bot containment, repeat contacts), satisfaction scores.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Change the metric to cost per resolved ticket, first-contact resolution and satisfaction.
Medium-term	Train a specialist queue for complex tickets. Check burnout and repeat contacts.
Long-term	AI-assisted replies for agents, and fix the causes of complex tickets (failed debits, KYC).

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Bot savings vs harder, longer tickets for agents and a risk of poor bot answers.
Should we fix it? Change the metric, not the process. Then watch satisfaction.
Size: Daily cost falls from ₹3.75 lakh to ₹3.24 lakh, about ₹0.5 lakh a day or ₹1.9 Cr a year.

Manager summary: Tickets per agent fell 15% because a bot now handles simple tickets, so agents get harder ones. Cost per resolved ticket actually fell 14%. I would change the metric and protect satisfaction.

Sources and tags: [Fact] Groww says it uses AI to answer client queries with zero wait (Q1 FY27 coverage). Notes: support satisfaction 38.33% (Satisfaction-IJRD, n = 60). Case numbers are made up.

Case 17 · Competitor cuts brokerage to zero

From PDF case 17 · free delivery response

Prompt: A major competitor announces zero brokerage on all orders. How should Groww respond?

1. Clarify

- Avoid the trap of 'match it'. First: how much client behaviour will really change?
- Is it a limited-time offer? Which products does it cover (delivery, intraday, F&O)?
- Assumption: brokerage revenue is ₹400 Cr a quarter. The offer covers all orders, with no end date.

2. Metric tree

Revenue at risk = sum of (segment share of brokerage revenue × switching risk)

Segment	Share of brokerage revenue	Switching risk	At risk (pts)
Heavy intraday and F&O traders	45%	12%	5.4
Active delivery traders	20%	6%	1.2
Occasional stock buyers	35%	2%	0.7
Total	100%		7.3 pts ≈ ₹29 Cr

₹400 Cr × 7.3% ≈ ₹29 Cr a quarter at risk.

3. Segment

Options and their economics (per quarter, made up).

Option	Cost	Protects	Verdict
Match zero brokerage	₹400 Cr	₹29 Cr	No
Targeted waiver for heavy traders at risk	₹15 Cr	about ₹22 Cr	Yes, test first
Volume-tier pricing	₹10 Cr	about ₹15 Cr	Maybe
Bundle research and margin benefits	₹5 Cr	about ₹8 Cr	Yes
Wait and watch with triggers	₹0	₹0 (risk stays ₹29 Cr)	Keep as the base

4. Test before committing

Test	Design	Success measure
Targeted waiver	Heavy traders at risk, 50/50 holdout, 6 weeks	Active traders and revenue vs holdout
Benefit bundle	Two cities, matched control	Retention and brokerage per client
Early warning	Weekly: transfers out, active-trader count	Alert if down 3% for two weeks

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Price is one reason clients choose an app, not the only one. Cost-effectiveness is rated only 36.67% satisfied in one sample, so low price alone does not win.
- Check if the offer is already changing behaviour: signups, transfers out, weekly active traders. Do not act on the headline alone.
- Validate with: finance (brokerage by segment), growth (switching signals), product.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Do not match. Set switching triggers. Protect heavy traders with a targeted offer.
Medium-term	Volume tiers and benefit bundles. Run the tests above.
Long-term	Make revenue less dependent on brokerage: lending, funds, commodities.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Protecting share now vs giving away revenue from clients who would stay anyway.
Should we fix it? Yes, but only with a targeted response.
Size: Matching costs ₹400 Cr to protect ₹29 Cr. A targeted waiver costing about ₹15 Cr protects about ₹22 Cr.

Manager summary: I would not match zero brokerage. About ₹29 Cr a quarter is at risk, concentrated in heavy traders, and matching costs ₹400 Cr. I would target those traders, test the response, and watch switching signals.

Sources and tags: [Fact] F&O is about 50% of revenue and stocks about 16% (Q1 FY27 coverage). Notes: cost-effectiveness satisfaction 36.67% (Satisfaction-IJRD, n = 60). Case numbers are made up.

Case 18 · Paid plan pilot: trials don't convert (hypothetical)

From PDF case 18 · membership stalled · HYPOTHETICAL

Prompt: Hypothetical: Groww pilots a paid plan (research, priority support, lower fees). Many users start a trial but few pay. Investigate.

1. Clarify

- Is the problem in seeing the offer, starting a trial, using it, or paying after it?
- What did the plan promise, and what does a trial user actually use?
- Assumption: this is hypothetical. I could not confirm Groww runs a paid plan. Target paid conversion is 25%.

2. Metric tree

Paid subscribers = eligible × saw offer × started trial × paid conversion

Stage	Count	Rate
Eligible users	1,000k	
Saw the offer	700k	70%
Started a trial	42k	6.0% of viewers
Used 2 or more benefits in week 1	9.2k	22% of trials
Paid after the trial	5.5k	13% of trials (target 25%)

3. Segment

Cut by benefit use. Users who experience value convert. Others do not.

Group	Share of trials	Paid conversion
Used 2 or more benefits	22%	41%
Used 0 or 1 benefit	78%	5%
Overall	100%	13%

Check: 0.22 × 41 + 0.78 × 5 ≈ 13. Likely further cut: heavy traders vs SIP investors.

4. Where value is lost during the trial

Day of the trial	Share who opened a benefit that day
Day 1	60%
Day 3	35%
Day 7	22%
Priority support (never used by 85% of trial users)	Not discovered

5. Root cause and who validates it

- It is an activation problem. Offer views and trial starts are fine. Trial users do not feel the value, so they do not pay.
- Price is a later question. Test it only after usage is fixed.
- Validate with: product analytics (benefit usage by day) and short interviews with trial users who did not pay.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Guided trial: a day-1 prompt to use the main benefit, a day-3 reminder, a day-6 summary of value received.
Medium-term	Find the hook benefit per segment (traders vs investors) and lead with it.
Long-term	Personalised plans by user type. Then a price test.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Fee discounts inside the plan may cannibalise brokerage revenue. Subscription revenue is steadier.
Should we fix it? Yes. Activation is cheaper to fix than acquisition.
Size: Raising week-1 use from 22% to 40% lifts conversion to about 19.4%, so subscribers rise from 5.5k to about 8.1k (+2.7k).

Manager summary: Trials do not convert because most trial users never use the benefits. Users who use two or more convert at 41%, others at 5%. I would improve trial onboarding before touching price.

Sources and tags: Hypothetical case. Notes: only 29.5% call in-app education 'very helpful' (Platforms-IJRPR, n = 44), so benefits must be concrete. Case numbers are made up.

Case 19 · Should Groww enter a new product line? (hypothetical)

From PDF case 19 · market entry · HYPOTHETICAL

Prompt: Hypothetical: the CEO is considering a new product line, such as wealth management, insurance or international investing. How would you evaluate it?

1. Clarify

- Define success: long-term value for shareholders. Can we replicate our strength (easy app, large retail base) in this line?
- What does the regulator allow, and who carries the risk?
- Assumption: three options are compared on the same scorecard. Scores are my judgement and made up.

2. Metric tree

Score = sum of (weight × score from 1 to 5)

Dimension	Weight	Wealth management	Insurance	International investing
Client demand	25%	3	4	3
Fit with current clients	20%	4	3	4
Unit economics	25%	4	3	3
Regulatory risk (5 = safest)	15%	3	2	3
Effort to build (5 = easiest)	15%	2	3	3
Weighted score		3.30	3.10	3.20

Check wealth: 0.25 × 3 + 0.20 × 4 + 0.25 × 4 + 0.15 × 3 + 0.15 × 2 = 3.30.

3. Segment

Who would use it? Test with the closest clients first.

Client group	Share of clients	Likely first product
High-balance MF-only investors	10%	Wealth management
SIP investors with families	25%	Insurance
Active stock traders	20%	International investing
New investors	45%	None yet (focus on basics)

4. Entry approach: stage gates

Gate	What we prove	Kill rule
0. Regulatory view	Rules allow it, confirmed in writing	Any unresolved rule risk
1. Pilot: 5% of eligible clients, 8 weeks	Take-up at least 3%, complaints under 2 per 1,000	Below either
2. Scale to 25%	Contribution margin per client positive, no hit to core NPS	Negative margin or NPS drop
3. Full launch	Targets held for two quarters	Review quarterly

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Main risks: regulation and focus. A launch can be reversed by a rule change. The candidate's note says a multi-bank FD marketplace was rolled back after SEBI rules (unverified, check before quoting).
- A new line must not pull engineering time from fixing core failures (cases 11 and 14).
- Validate with: compliance and legal (gate 0), finance (unit economics), product.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Get a written regulatory view. Pick one option for a pilot.
Medium-term	Run gates 1 and 2 with kill rules agreed in advance.
Long-term	Scale only the option that meets targets for two quarters.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Breadth (more products per client) vs focus (core reliability).
Should we fix it? Not a fix: a bet. Place it small, with kill rules.
Size: If 1% of 10M clients buy at ₹2,000 a year, that is 100k × ₹2,000 = ₹20 Cr a year.

Manager summary: I would score the options on demand, fit, economics, regulation and effort. Wealth management scores highest here. I would clear the regulatory view first, then pilot with 5% of clients and agreed kill rules.

Sources and tags: Hypothetical case. [Fact] Groww's AMC AUM grew 140% in a year (Q1 FY27 coverage). The FD marketplace rollback is the candidate's own note and is unverified. Case numbers and scores are made up.

Case 20 · CEO asks: How is the business doing?

From PDF case 20 · CEO readout

Prompt: You have 10 minutes with the CEO. How would you summarise business performance?

1. Clarify

- What decision does the CEO need to make? Which period? Assumption: a quarterly review.
- Do not show 100 metrics. Answer: what is happening, why, and what to do.
- Group metrics into growth, client health, risk and financials.

2. Metric tree

Executive view = growth + client health + risk + financials

Area	Metric	Value	Tag	Read
Growth	Revenue from operations (Q1 FY27)	₹1,501 Cr, +66% YoY	[Fact]	Strong
Growth	Net active NSE clients	+1.15 lakh (industry -2.6 lakh)	[Fact]	Gaining share
Client health	90-day repeat rate of new users	38% (was 43%)	Made up	Watch
Client health	NPS	51 (was 62)	Made up	Fix
Risk	F&O share of revenue	about 50%	[Fact]	Top risk
Risk	MTF share of revenue	8% (was 3%)	[Fact]	Watch credit
Operations	Failed orders at open on peak days	3.4%	Made up	Fix now
Financials	PAT margin	47.5% as reported	[Fact]	Strong

3. Segment

Prioritise: impact × urgency × ease (each 1 to 5).

Issue	Impact	Urgency	Ease	Score
Order failures at open	4	5	4	80
F&O dependence	5	4	2	40
MTF credit quality	4	2	4	32
New-investor repeat rate	3	3	3	27

4. The story in three beats

Beat	What to say
What happened	Revenue grew 66% YoY and we gained clients while the industry lost them.
Why	Diversification is working: commodities, lending and funds grew. Operating leverage lifted margin.
Risks	F&O is still half of revenue. Peak-day failures hurt NPS. Credit quality needs watching as MTF grows.

5. Root cause and who validates it

- Not every issue deserves attention. I would raise two: order failures (fast, high impact) and F&O dependence (slow, high impact).
- Expected CEO follow-ups: what would you stop? what is the cost of the fix? when will we see results?
- Validate with: finance (numbers), engineering and risk (the two issues), product.

6. Recommendation

When	Action
Immediate	Fix order failures at open. Set credit alerts for MTF.
Medium-term	A target for F&O share of revenue and a plan to reach it.
Long-term	A scorecard with owners and weekly review, so leadership never has to ask this question cold.

7. Manager-level answer

Trade-off: Reporting more metrics vs giving a clear decision. Leaders need the second.
Should we fix it? Top two issues only.
Size: Use the scores above to rank. Quote ₹ impact where you can.

Manager summary: Revenue grew 66% and we gained clients in a weak market. Two risks need action: peak-day order failures hurting traders, and F&O still being about half of revenue. I would fix failures this month and set a diversification target.

Sources and tags: [Fact] Groww Q1 FY27 results coverage: revenue ₹1,501 Cr (+66%), PAT ₹735 Cr (+94%), PAT margin 47.5% as reported, MTF 8% of revenue vs 3%, F&O about 50%, +1.15 lakh net active NSE clients vs industry -2.6 lakh. Other numbers are made up.

Follow-up questions after your answer

Interviewers often decide between 'analyst' and 'manager' on these. Prepare one line for each.

1. Which metric would you prioritise, and why?

How to answer: Pick the metric closest to money that a team can change. Say why it moves first. Name one guardrail beside it.

Groww example: 'For MF I would use net active SIPs. It moves before revenue and the team can change it. The guardrail is early cancellations.'

2. What trade-offs are you making?

How to answer: Name the pair. Say what you give up and by roughly how much.

Groww example: 'Targeting heavy traders with a waiver costs about ₹15 Cr but protects about ₹22 Cr. I give up fairness across segments.'

3. How would you estimate the financial impact?

How to answer: Affected users × change in rate × value per user × time. Use contribution margin, not revenue. Give a range and state assumptions.

Groww example: 'Restoring Android payments adds about 18.9k deposits a week. At about ₹400 contribution each a quarter, that is a few crore a quarter.'

4. What if engineering is limited?

How to answer: Order of effort: fix leaks first (failed payments, failed debits), then message or configuration changes, then new features. Say what you would stop.

Groww example: 'I would retry failed SIP debits and message clients before building any new setup flow.'

5. How would you convince a skeptical VP?

How to answer: Lead with money at risk. Show one chart. Offer the smallest test. Agree a stop rule and a review date.

Groww example: 'About ₹29 Cr a quarter is at risk. I'd test a targeted waiver on 50% of heavy traders for six weeks and stop if retention does not improve.'

Sizing recipes

Use these when asked 'how big is the prize?'. Always say the assumption.

Situation	Formula	Example from this playbook
Fix a funnel leak	Users at the step × lift in step rate × value per converted user	Case 2: 70% × 180k × 15 pts = 18.9k deposits a week
Retain more clients	Clients at risk × share saved × margin per client per month × months	Case 6: 5% of traders leaving ≈ 2.5% of revenue
Pricing or competitor response	Segment share of revenue × switching risk × revenue	Case 17: ₹400 Cr × 7.3% ≈ ₹29 Cr at risk
Return on spend	Incremental value ÷ spend (never total revenue ÷ spend)	Case 8: ₹9 Cr ÷ ₹20 Cr = 0.45x
Cost saving	Avoided events × cost per event	Case 4: 0.3 fewer tickets per client × 10M clients × ₹100 ≈ ₹30 Cr
Cannibalisation	New revenue - revenue that shifted from another line	Case 7: ₹60 Cr - ₹18 Cr = ₹42 Cr
Mix vs rate	Overall change = change from mix + change from segment rates	Case 3: -5 pts mix, about 0 pts rate
Outage cost	Extra failed orders × revenue per order	Case 11: 17.5k × ₹20 = ₹3.5 lakh a day

Four rules

- Use **contribution margin**, not revenue, when you compare options.
- Give a **range** (low, base, high) if the input is uncertain.
- Say what **you assume** (for example that rates hold at scale). Returns usually shrink as spend grows.
- Compare the size with the **cost and time** of the fix before you recommend it.

Trade-off cheat sheet

The sentence that separates a manager answer from an analyst answer.

#	Trade-off	Decision rule
1	Protect F&O vs diversify	Protect top traders and diversify. Do not push small traders back into F&O.
2	Rollback vs delaying features	Roll back if the release explains most of the loss.
3	IPO volume vs repeat quality	Report mix-adjusted rates. Act only on segments that got worse.
4	Growth vs unit cost	Judge lending cost on margin. Cut support cost by fixing failures.
5	Acquisition vs activation	Fix leaks after signup before buying more signups.
6	Peak capacity cost vs trust	Fix peak-day failures first.
7	Share vs margin	Judge on incremental margin after cannibalisation.
8	Volume vs return	Pay only where incremental ROI is above 1x.
9	Installs vs funded users	Optimise for funded users, not installs.
10	Market effect vs controllable flows	Separate market effect from flow effect. Fix only flows.
11	Spare capacity vs trust	Add capacity where failures concentrate.
12	Volume vs value	Keep channels above about 2x value ÷ cost.
13	Relevance vs revenue per click	Relevance first. Keep contracts in a separate tab.
14	Friction vs recovery	Retry and message before redesigning the flow.
15	Conversion vs investor harm	Ship only if the guardrails hold.
16	Bot savings vs complex tickets	Judge on cost per resolved ticket and satisfaction.
17	Match vs target	Do not match when revenue at risk is far below the cost of matching.
18	Fee cuts vs subscription revenue	Fix usage before price.
19	Breadth vs focus	Pilot small with kill rules agreed in advance.
20	Metrics vs a decision	Top two issues only, ranked by impact × urgency × ease.

Say this, not that

Small changes in wording show careful thinking.

Instead of	Say
'Revenue fell, so run more campaigns.'	'I'd split revenue into traders × orders × revenue per order first.'
'Users are not interested.'	'Visibility and interest look the same in a funnel. I'd ask for exposure data by cohort.'
'The A/B test won, ship it.'	'Let me check the guardrails and the quality of the extra users first.'
'Conversion is up, great.'	'Is it incremental, and what happened to early losses and retention?'
'Match the competitor's price.'	'I'd quantify revenue at risk by segment before deciding.'
'The SIP stoppage ratio is 78%, so 78% of investors quit.'	'The ratio includes SIPs that completed their term. It is not the share who quit.'
'Education improves retention.'	'Notes suggest education raises intent to keep using. Usage did not link to learning (r = -0.148, n = 102). I'd test with a quiz.'
'Groww has 50% share (from a survey).'	'That figure is a sample artefact in a 44-person survey.'
Quoting a German or South African study as Indian data	'This is from another country. I'd use it for patterns and test it here.'
'We'll fix everything.'	'Top two issues, ranked by impact × urgency × ease.'
'Retention fell, the product is worse.'	'Let me check mix first. Segments may be stable while the mix shifted.'
'I don't know.'	'Here is what I'd check first, and what each result would tell us.'

Numbers you can quote

Real figures with their sources and cautions. Everything else in this playbook is made up for practice.

Number	Meaning	Source	Caution
About 50% / about 16%	F&O and stocks share of Groww revenue (Q1 FY27)	Results coverage	News coverage. Check the shareholder letter
8% vs 3%	MTF share of revenue, now vs a year ago	Results coverage	Same
29%	Commodity derivatives market share in under a year	Results coverage	Same
+140%	Groww AMC assets under management, one year	Results coverage	Same
+1.15 lakh vs -2.6 lakh	Net active NSE clients: Groww vs industry (Q1 FY27)	Results coverage	Same
₹1,501 Cr / ₹735 Cr	Q1 FY27 revenue (+66%) and profit (+94%)	Results coverage	PAT margin 47.5% as reported
₹32,490 Cr / 78.53%	Industry SIP inflows and stoppage ratio, Sep 2026	AMFI, via news	Stoppage includes completed SIPs
87.5 lakh	Individual F&O traders in FY26, first fall in nearly a decade	News coverage	Industry, not Groww
₹91,685 Cr	Retail F&O losses in FY26	News coverage	Context only
45.5% + 9.1%	Occasional + frequent crashes or delays	Platforms-IJRPR	n = 44
66.67%	Connectivity issues at least sometimes	Satisfaction-IJRD	n = 60
68.3% / 66.67%	Confused by a mixed app / want separate sections	Satisfaction-IJRD	n = 60
29.5%	Say in-app education is 'very helpful'	Platforms-IJRPR	n = 44
78% / 61.67%	Trade more / take more risk after using apps	Satisfaction-IJRD	n = 60, self-reported
52.9% / r = -0.148	Use apps rarely / usage vs literacy gain	Literacy-IJCRM	n = 102; paper's text contradicts the r
80%	Apps deleted within 90 days	Retention-UCT	Not India. Secondary citation

Unconfirmed, do not quote yet: 74% complexity and information gaps, 73% risk and return worries, 51% trust and transparency, 36% medium or high knowledge, about 50% low knowledge, and state-wise shares (Delhi 21%, Maharashtra 17%, Goa 16%, Gujarat 15%). The source was not stated. Confirm in the SEBI Investor Survey 2025 first.

Your routine in the room

Run this in your head on every case. It takes about 30 seconds to set up.

#	Do this	Check
1	Say the goal back in one line	Did I answer the question that was asked?
2	Ask 2 or 3 questions, then state an assumption	Metric defined? Period? Scope?
3	Write the formula and put numbers in it	Does the arithmetic add up?
4	Cut by product, cohort, channel, platform	Which cut moved most?
5	Walk the funnel and compute each step rate	Which step is lowest? Which is next?
6	Name a cause with a data signature and a validator	What else would I see if this were true?
7	Recommend: immediate, medium, long	Is the first move cheap and quick?
8	Add trade-off, should we fix it, size	Cost of fix vs money at stake?
9	Three-sentence summary: what, why, action	Could a CEO repeat it?
10	Finish: one recommendation, one number, one risk	Did I say all three?

If you get stuck

- Compute the step rates. The lowest one is usually the story.
- Say what the numbers already rule out (for example 'visibility is not the problem here').
- Ask for the one piece of data that would separate two causes.
- Check if the headline moved because of mix, not because segments got worse.
- Do not list everything you know. Pick the most likely cause and say how you would test it.

Decision cases (17 to 20): use this order

Exposure (who is at risk, how much) → Economics (cost vs money protected) → Alternatives (at least three) → Test before committing → Recommendation with a stop rule.

Before you walk in

- Know three real facts about Groww cold: F&O is about half of revenue, MTF is 8%, commodities share is 29%.
- Know two risks you would raise: F&O dependence and peak-day failures.
- Know one thing you would do first: fix failures that hurt trust and cost money (payments, SIP debits, orders at open).